

HOUSE RULES

FOR THE DALELANDS CAMPAIGN

These rules draw from gritty realism, Critical Role inspirations, and excursion-style adventuring to heighten stakes, reward clever play, and evoke a living, dangerous Forgotten Realms region.

POTIONS

Potions represent a **significant investment** and provide substantial aid. They are scarcer and more costly than standard, but **heal for maximum hit points** when consumed.

Potion Name	Rarity	Cost (gp)
Potion of Healing	Common	50
Potion of Greater Healing	Uncommon	150
Potion of Superior Healing	Rare	450
Potion of Supreme Healing	Very Rare	1,350

CRITICAL HITS — GRITTY REALISM

Critical hits strike with greater force.

On a critical hit: Tally the **maximum value of all damage dice** rolled and add that total as a flat bonus to the normal hit. Modifiers are **not** doubled.

This applies to **player characters and monsters**.

Example

A greataxe crit (2d12) rolls normal damage + 24 (max dice total). A dragon's bite crit adds its full max dice value on top.

MINIONS (DM MECHANIC)

Use standard **minion rules** for low-HP fodder enemies:

- 1 HP (any damage kills).
- No death saves or lingering effects.
- Streamlines large combats.

LINGERING INJURIES — ESCALATING EXHAUSTION

A character gains **one level of exhaustion** when any of these occur:

- They suffer a **critical hit**.
- They **drop to 0 hit points** (but are not killed outright).
- They **fail a death saving throw by 5 or more** (roll 10 or lower).

2024 EXHAUSTION EFFECTS

Level	d20 Penalty	Speed Reduction
1	-2	-5 ft.
2	-4	-10 ft.
3	-6	-15 ft.
4	-8	-20 ft.
5	-10	-25 ft.
6	Death	Immediate

- **Recovery:** A **long rest** reduces exhaustion by **1 level**.
- Other causes: environmental extremes, starvation, certain spells/monsters.

RESURRECTION

Matt Mercer's "Fading Spirit" Rules (Critical Role / Tal'Dorei). Death carries lasting weight.

The soul must be **free and willing** to return.

SPELLS WITH >1 ACTION (RAISE DEAD, RESURRECTION, REINCARNATE)

1. Up to **3 party members** make **skill checks** (DM chooses skill & sets DC: easy/medium/hard). Advantage/disadvantage possible.
2. **Final DC = 10 + number of prior successful resurrections** for this character.

- Success → **-3** to final DC
- Failure → **+1** to final DC

3. DM rolls **straight d20** vs. final DC.

Result	Outcome
Success	Revival succeeds (if willing).
Failure	Soul lost forever (only <i>true resurrection</i> or <i>wish</i> bypass).

1-ACTION SPELLS (REVIVIFY)

Caster rolls **d20 + spellcasting modifier** vs. **DC 10 + prior resurrections**.

Result	Outcome
Success	Revival.
Failure	Fails; +1 to all future DCs for this character. No more 1-action revives until a full ritual succeeds.

BYPASSES

- *True Resurrection* or *Wish* — auto-succeed.
- Divine intervention — instant (DM discretion).

Notes — Track resurrections per character. Adjust severity for campaign tone.

RESTING

SHORT REST

Taken **anywhere** over the course of **8 hours**.
Requires **6 hours of sleep** + up to **2 hours light activity**.
Interrupted and reset by:

- Rolling initiative (entering combat)
- Casting a spell using a **spell slot** (cantrips/rituals allowed)
- Taking **any damage**

LONG REST

Achieved in **one of two ways:**

Method	Requirements
Three consecutive short rests	In the same location , no interruptions
Safe haven	Single night in a player built/earned/taken base of operations (e.g., bastion)



A True Safe Haven